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Agile Principles

Introduction:

The agile manifesto, penned over two decades ago, serves as a foundational guide for software development practices. Crafted by a group of seasoned practitioners, it advocates for a human centric approach to product development, prioritizing collaboration, adaptability and continuous improvement. Rooted in four core values and twelve guiding principles, the manifesto champions a mindset shift towards iterative delivery, customer engagement, responsiveness to change etc. As agile methodologies continue to evolve, understanding and embodying these principles remain paramount for teams striving for efficiency and innovation in software development and beyond.

Agile Manifesto Values:

1) Individuals & interactions over processes & tools - It focuses on human collaboration and communication. Ex- Agile teams prioritize face-to-face conversations

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2) Working Software over Comprehensive documentation-

It emphasizes tangible outcomes rather than extensive planning. Ex- Delivering usable software increments rather than exhaustive project documentation.

3) Customer Collaboration over contract negotiation-

Engaging customers throughout the development process. Ex- Regularly gathering feedback to adapt to changing customer needs.

4) Responding to change over following a plan-

Every one needs to keep in mind that flexibility and adaptability are key. Ex- Welcoming changing requirements to improve product competitiveness.

Agile Manifesto Principles:

1) Satisfy the customer- customer satisfaction is achieved through early and continuous delivery, emphasizing incremental, frequent releases of valuable software. For instance, Agile teams strive to deliver usable product increments every few weeks.

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2) Welcome changing requirements - Agile processes welcome changing requirements as a means to gain competitive advantage, adapting to evolving customer needs even late in development for improved outcomes.

3) Deliver working software frequently - Delivering working softwares frequently involves adhering to regular, shorter delivery cycles. Agile teams typically aim for shorter timescales, ensuring usable software is delivered every few weeks.

4) Business works with developers daily - Daily collaboration between business people and developers fosters transparency and alignment. Regular meetings ensure ongoing communication and a shared understanding of project objectives.

5) Build projects around motivated individuals - Projects are built around motivated individuals, providing them with necessary support and autonomy to achieve success. Agile teams trust motivated individuals to accomplish project goals effectively.

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6) Face to Face conversations Best - Effective communication is facilitated through face-to-face conversations, enhancing understanding and collaboration in real-time. Agile teams prioritize direct interactions over written communication.

7) Working software matters - Working software serves as the primary measure of progress, demostrating tangible advancements in project delivery. Success is gauged by the usability of product increments rather than strict adherence to initial plans.

8) Constant Pace - Sustainable development is promotes to ensure long-term success, maintaining a steady pace to prevent burnout and uphold quality standards. Agile methodologies support a sustainable pace for consistent progress.

9) High quality code is faster - Continuous attention to technical excellence and good design is essential for fostering innovation and maintaining good quality. Technical excellence is prioritized to prevent accumulation of technical debt and drive innovation forward.

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10) Maximize work not done - simplicity is upheld to maximize valuable work, avoiding unnecessary complexity to optimize efficiency. Agile teams focus on the most valuable tasks, prioritizing impactful work over superflous requirements.

11) Self-organizing teams deliver quality - Architectures, requirements, designs emerge from self-organizing teams through collaborative decision making, fostering innovation and adaptability.

12) Feedback loops used to improve - Regular reflection and adjustements are embraced for continuous improvement, fostering iterative learning and adaptation for enhanced effectiveness.

To sum up, embracing agile principles fosters effective project management and team dynamics, enabling organizations to navigate challenges with agility.

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